

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 9: Types of Governments

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	9 — Types of Governments
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. A country with a king can still be a democracy (the UK is both a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary democracy); India is a parliamentary democracy even though it has a President because real executive power rests with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers; and democracy means far more than merely holding elections. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. Country X holds free elections every five years, has courts that have ruled against the government, and protects the right to criticise leaders. Country Y holds elections every five years too, but one party controls the judges and jails critics. Which is more accurately a democracy, and why?

- (A) Country X, because democracy needs not just elections but also rule of law, an independent judiciary and protected freedoms
- (B) Country Y, because holding regular elections is by itself the complete test of a democracy
- (C) Both equally, because each country holds elections on the same schedule
- (D) Neither, because true democracy forbids having any organised political party

2. A student argues: 'The United Kingdom has a king, so it cannot be a democracy.' What is the strongest correction?

- (A) The argument is correct, because the presence of any monarch always rules out democracy
- (B) The UK is a constitutional monarchy where the monarch is only a nominal head while an elected parliament holds real power, so it is also a parliamentary democracy

(C) The UK actually has no monarch, so the question does not arise

(D) The UK is a democracy only because its king is elected by the people every term

3. India has a President, yet it is called a parliamentary democracy rather than a presidential one. The best explanation is that:

(A) India's President personally governs the country and is therefore the head of government

(B) Real executive power is exercised by the Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers, who must keep the confidence of the elected legislature, while the President is a largely nominal head

(C) India has both a President and a Prime Minister, and any country with two such posts is automatically presidential

(D) The President of India is directly elected by all voters, which makes the system presidential

4. In a presidential system such as the USA, and a parliamentary system such as India, which statement correctly captures the key contrast about the head of government?

(A) In both systems the head of government is a hereditary monarch chosen at birth

(B) In the presidential system the head of government is elected separately and is independent of the legislature; in the parliamentary system the head of government comes from the legislature and must retain its confidence

(C) In the parliamentary system the head of government is elected separately from the legislature, while in the presidential system the head comes from the legislature

(D) In both systems the courts appoint the head of government

5. A country is ruled by a single leader who controls who makes the laws, who enforces them and who judges disputes, with no constitution limiting him. This is best classified as a:

(A) Constitutional monarchy, because one person sits at the top

(B) Direct democracy, because the leader makes decisions quickly

(C) Dictatorship, because one person holds absolute, unchecked power across all functions

(D) Republic, because the leader is not called a king

6. Assertion: A democracy can have a king. Reason: In a constitutional monarchy the monarch's powers are mostly nominal while an elected legislature governs. Choose the correct option.

(A) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion

(B) Both are true, but the reason does not explain the assertion

(C) The assertion is true but the reason is false

(D) The assertion is false but the reason is true

7. Why do most large modern countries use representative democracy rather than direct democracy?

- (A) Direct democracy has been outlawed everywhere in the world
- (B) Citizens in large countries are not allowed to hold any opinions
- (C) It is impractical for millions of citizens to gather and vote directly on every single decision, so they elect representatives to decide for them
- (D) Representatives in large countries are always hereditary monarchs

8. A nation lets every adult vote, but afterwards the winning majority passes a law stripping a minority group of its rights. A correct democracy would NOT allow this because:

- (A) In a democracy the majority is entitled to do absolutely anything it votes for
- (B) Only the king may decide who keeps their rights
- (C) Minorities are never allowed to vote, so the question cannot arise
- (D) Democracy protects fundamental rights of all, so a majority cannot simply vote away the rights of a minority

9. An 'oligarchy' is best distinguished from a democracy by the fact that in an oligarchy:

- (A) Every adult citizen votes on each major law
- (B) A small, powerful group, often wealthy families, makes the important decisions rather than the people as a whole
- (C) A single hereditary monarch holds all power
- (D) Religious leaders rule strictly by sacred law

10. A country holds regular votes, but in practice one wealthy family quietly controls the courts, the lawmakers and the newspapers. This is best described as:

- (A) A healthy, fully functioning democracy
- (B) A constitutional monarchy
- (C) An oligarchy wearing the appearance of a democracy
- (D) A direct democracy

11. Which scenario best illustrates 'direct democracy' rather than 'representative democracy'?

- (A) Citizens elect a council, and the council members decide whether to build the park
- (B) All the residents of a small town gather and themselves vote yes or no on whether to build a new park
- (C) A mayor inherits the office and announces that a park will be built
- (D) A national parliament passes a budget that funds many parks

12. A 'referendum' differs from an ordinary parliamentary election because in a referendum:

- (A) Citizens choose which representatives will sit in parliament
- (B) Citizens vote directly to decide a single question themselves rather than choosing representatives

- (C) Only judges cast votes to settle the matter
- (D) A king issues the final decision after consulting nobles

13. Which of the following correctly pairs a country with its standard textbook classification of government?

- (A) United States — constitutional monarchy(B) India — presidential democracy
- (C) United Kingdom — constitutional monarchy and parliamentary democracy
- (D) Saudi Arabia — direct democracy

14. Separation of powers protects democracy mainly because it:

- (A) Lets the executive take charge of the courts so decisions are faster
- (B) Stops any single organ of government from gaining total control and abusing power
- (C) Concentrates all authority in the legislature(D) Removes the need for any laws at all

15. In an absolute monarchy versus a constitutional monarchy, the crucial difference is that:

- (A) In an absolute monarchy the monarch truly holds and exercises ruling power, while in a constitutional monarchy the monarch is largely nominal and an elected body governs
- (B) In both the monarch is purely ceremonial and elected bodies govern
- (C) In an absolute monarchy the king is elected, while in a constitutional monarchy the king inherits the throne
- (D) In a constitutional monarchy the king personally makes every law, while in an absolute monarchy the king has no power

16. Saudi Arabia and the United Kingdom are both monarchies, yet only one is also a democracy. The best explanation is:

- (A) Both kings rule absolutely, so neither country is a democracy
- (B) Saudi Arabia is an absolute monarchy where the king governs, while the UK is a constitutional monarchy where an elected parliament governs under a nominal king
- (C) Both are democracies because each simply has a monarch
- (D) The UK is a democracy because its monarch is elected, while Saudi Arabia's is not

17. Which feature is essential to a democracy but absent in a dictatorship?

- (A) A capital city where the government sits(B) An army to defend the borders
- (C) A national flag and anthem
- (D) Genuine accountability of the rulers to the people who can replace them through free elections

18. 'Universal adult franchise' is a pillar of modern democracy because it ensures that:

- (A) Only adults who own land are permitted to vote
- (B) Only members of the government may cast a vote

- (C) Every citizen above a certain age has the right to vote, regardless of wealth, gender or property
- (D) Voting is restricted to one gender

19. An independent judiciary strengthens democracy chiefly because it can:

- (A) Always rule in favour of the ruling party to keep order
- (B) Take orders from the head of government on every case
- (C) Give only advice to a hereditary king
- (D) Decide cases fairly even against the government, ensuring that laws and rights are upheld

20. Compare a 'theocracy' with a 'democracy'. The key difference is that in a theocracy:

- (A) Every adult votes directly on all laws
- (B) A small group of wealthy families makes all decisions
- (C) The country is governed by religious rules and religious leaders rather than by the elected will of the people
- (D) A nominal monarch reigns while parliament governs

21. A 'republic' and a 'democracy' are not identical because a republic specifically requires that:

- (A) All voting be abolished
- (B) The country always keep a hereditary king
- (C) The head of state is elected and not a hereditary monarch
- (D) Religious leaders choose the rulers

22. India is best described as a 'democratic republic' because it is:

- (A) Ruled by the people through elected representatives and has an elected, non-hereditary head of state
- (B) Ruled by a hereditary king with ceremonial ministers
- (C) Governed strictly according to religious law
- (D) Controlled by a single small group of wealthy families

23. Which situation most clearly shows that 'holding an election' alone does not make a country a real democracy?

- (A) A country votes, and its courts can overturn government actions found unlawful
- (B) A country votes, and citizens freely criticise their leaders in newspapers
- (C) A country votes, and minorities enjoy the same rights as the majority
- (D) A country votes, but critics of the government are jailed and the courts obey the ruling party

24. In which form of government is power most clearly passed down within one family by birth?

- (A) Representative democracy
- (B) Oligarchy
- (C) Monarchy
- (D) Republic

25. The three organs of government and their core jobs are correctly matched in which option?

- (A) Legislature makes laws, executive carries them out, judiciary settles disputes and ensures laws are followed
- (B) Legislature carries out laws, executive settles disputes, judiciary makes laws
- (C) Legislature settles disputes, executive makes laws, judiciary carries them out
- (D) Legislature, executive and judiciary all only make laws

26. A court strikes down a government order because it violates the law. This action belongs to which function of government?

- (A) Legislative
- (B) Executive
- (C) Ceremonial
- (D) Judicial

27. Why does a dictatorship lack genuine 'accountability', unlike a democracy?

- (A) Its ruler must face the voters every few years and can be voted out
- (B) Its ruler need not answer to the people and cannot be removed by them through free elections
- (C) Its courts are fully independent and can remove the ruler
- (D) Its parliament freely questions and replaces the ruler

28. Two democracies are compared. In the first, the head of government can be removed mid-term if the legislature withdraws its confidence; in the second, the separately elected head serves a fixed term independent of the legislature. These are respectively:

- (A) A presidential system and a parliamentary system
- (B) An absolute monarchy and a constitutional monarchy
- (C) A parliamentary system and a presidential system
- (D) A theocracy and an oligarchy

29. The deepest question that separates a democracy from a dictatorship is:

- (A) How large the country's population is
- (B) Which language most citizens speak
- (C) Who holds power and how the government is chosen and held accountable
- (D) How much territory the country controls

30. Which statement about 'rule of law' in a democracy is correct?

- (A) Leaders stand above the law and cannot be questioned
- (B) Even the government and its leaders are bound by the law, just like ordinary citizens
- (C) Only ordinary citizens must obey the law, never the rulers
- (D) The law applies only during election years

31. A country's constitution guarantees every citizen freedom of speech and equal treatment, and an independent court can enforce these against the government. These features together best show that the country is a:

- (A) Dictatorship
- (B) Democracy
- (C) Absolute monarchy
- (D) Oligarchy

32. In India, if the Lok Sabha passes a vote of no confidence in the government, the most accurate consequence is that:

- (A) The Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister must resign, showing the executive depends on the legislature's confidence
- (B) Nothing changes, because the Prime Minister is elected separately for a fixed term
- (C) The President is automatically removed from office
- (D) The Supreme Court must dissolve and elect a new government

33. Which best captures why 'democracy' is more than just majority rule?

- (A) Because the majority is allowed to override every right whenever it wishes
- (B) Because only the minority is ever allowed to decide
- (C) Because there are no rules limiting any group at all
- (D) Alongside majority decisions it protects the rights of minorities and individuals through a constitution and limits on power

34. A government is run by a small council of the five richest families, who pass laws to protect their own wealth and exclude everyone else from power. This is a:

- (A) Direct democracy
- (B) Oligarchy
- (C) Constitutional monarchy
- (D) Theocracy

35. Even a real democracy can 'drift toward oligarchy' if:

- (A) More ordinary citizens turn out to vote in elections
- (B) A small, powerful group gains so much control that ordinary citizens' votes stop shaping decisions
- (C) The courts become more independent of the government
- (D) Fundamental rights become better protected for everyone

36. Which of these is the clearest example of a country being both a monarchy and a democracy at the same time?

- (A) A nation where a hereditary king personally makes and enforces every law
- (B) A nation where elections have been banned and a king rules alone
- (C) A nation with no monarch and an elected president
- (D) A nation where an elected parliament makes the laws while a hereditary monarch serves only as a ceremonial head of state

37. The chapter's 'Peek into History' examples (the Vajji, ancient Greece and Rome) are meant to show that:

- (A) The idea of the ruled choosing their rulers is ancient and arose in several civilisations, not only in modern times
- (B) Democracy was invented entirely in the twenty-first century

- (C) Only one civilisation in history ever tried any form of self-rule
- (D) Elections were impossible before the modern age

38. The Uttaramerur inscriptions are historically valuable because they show that:

- (A) India held no elections of any kind before modern times
- (B) Only hereditary kings ever held power throughout Indian history
- (C) Organised elections to choose representatives existed in India long ago
- (D) Elections were a practice found only in ancient Greece

39. The Lichchhavi clan, an early Indian example of people choosing their leaders, belonged to which confederation?

- (A) The Magadha empire of the Mauryas
- (B) The Chola kingdom of the south
- (C) The Kushana empire of the northwest
- (D) The Vajji

40. Despite its imperfections, the chapter concludes that democracy is:

- (A) The rarest form of government on Earth
- (B) A system that no country actually uses
- (C) The most popular form of government in the world today
- (D) Identical in practice to a dictatorship

41. A representative in a democracy is best understood as:

- (A) A person who rules because of the family he was born into
- (B) A person chosen by others to make decisions on their behalf
- (C) Simply the wealthiest person in the community
- (D) A judge appointed to settle legal disputes

42. Which pair correctly contrasts where 'sovereignty' or ultimate power rests?

- (A) In a democracy power flows from the people; in an absolute monarchy it rests with the hereditary ruler
- (B) In a democracy power rests with a hereditary ruler; in an absolute monarchy it flows from the people
- (C) In both, power rests entirely with the courts
- (D) In both, power rests with foreign governments

43. A new country wants to ensure no single leader can dominate. Which design choice best serves this goal?

- (A) Dividing power among an independent legislature, executive and judiciary so each checks the others
- (B) Letting one elected leader also appoint all judges and control lawmaking
- (C) Abolishing the courts to speed up decisions
- (D) Giving the army authority over the legislature and the judiciary

44. Which best explains why elections must be 'free and fair', not merely held, for a democracy?

- (A) Because elections are only a formality with no real effect on power
- (B) Because only the ruling party should be allowed to contest
- (C) If voters are intimidated or results are rigged, the vote no longer reflects the people's genuine choice
- (D) Because the outcome should be decided in advance by the rulers

45. A government where religious leaders rule the state according to sacred law is a:

- (A) Theocracy
- (B) Republic
- (C) Direct democracy
- (D) Constitutional monarchy

46. Why is it accurate to say the UK is a democracy even though it has never elected its monarch?

- (A) The monarch's role is nominal, and the country is governed by a parliament that the people elect
- (B) Because the monarch is secretly elected by the people
- (C) Because the monarch personally makes all the laws after winning a vote
- (D) Because having any monarch automatically makes a country democratic

47. Which statement about a dictatorship is correct?

- (A) Power is shared among many freely elected representatives
- (B) The people vote directly on every law that is passed
- (C) The ruler's authority is purely ceremonial
- (D) Power is held with no real constitutional limit and the ruler is not genuinely answerable to the people

48. A class chooses a small committee to make decisions instead of having every student vote on each matter. This is most like which form of government?

- (A) Absolute monarchy
- (B) Theocracy
- (C) Representative democracy
- (D) Dictatorship

49. Assertion: Holding elections proves a country is a democracy. Reason: Democracy also requires equality, rights and an independent judiciary. Choose the correct option.

- (A) The assertion is false but the reason is true
- (B) Both the assertion and the reason are true
- (C) Both are false
- (D) The assertion is true but the reason is false

50. Which of these would most strongly indicate that a country labelled a 'democracy' is failing to live up to the name?

- (A) Opposition parties campaign openly and sometimes win elections
- (B) Newspapers freely report on government mistakes
- (C) Courts occasionally overturn unlawful government actions
- (D) Citizens cannot criticise the government, and courts never rule against it

- 51.** Compare a republic with a constitutional monarchy. Both can be democracies, but they differ in that:
- (A) A republic has an elected head of state, while a constitutional monarchy keeps a hereditary monarch as nominal head
 - (B) A republic keeps a hereditary king while a constitutional monarchy elects its head of state
 - (C) Only the constitutional monarchy can be a democracy
 - (D) Neither can hold elections of any kind
- 52.** The function of government that involves debating and passing a new law is the:
- (A) Executive function
 - (B) Judicial function
 - (C) Electoral function
 - (D) Legislative function
- 53.** A country's head of state is chosen by an election and serves a fixed term; there is no king or queen. The country is therefore a:
- (A) Constitutional monarchy
 - (B) Republic
 - (C) Absolute monarchy
 - (D) Theocracy
- 54.** In a parliamentary democracy, the relationship between the executive and the legislature is best described as:
- (A) The executive is elected entirely separately and cannot be removed by the legislature mid-term
 - (B) The executive and legislature are the same single person
 - (C) The executive is drawn from the legislature and stays in office only while it holds the legislature's confidence
 - (D) The executive controls the legislature and can abolish it at will
- 55.** A monarch reigns but a written constitution and an elected parliament actually make and enforce the laws. Which traditional claim does this country disprove?
- (A) The claim that democracies hold elections
 - (B) The claim that monarchs can inherit their position
 - (C) The claim that parliaments can make laws
 - (D) The claim that any country with a king or queen cannot be a democracy
- 56.** Which best explains why accountability is easier to enforce in a democracy than in a dictatorship?
- (A) In a dictatorship, citizens vote leaders out every year, but in a democracy they cannot
 - (B) In both, leaders are equally answerable to the people
 - (C) In a democracy, leaders are above the law and need not answer to anyone
 - (D) In a democracy, citizens can question leaders and vote them out, while a dictator faces no such check

57. Which scenario best fits an 'absolute monarchy' rather than a 'constitutional monarchy'?

- (A) A king issues laws, commands the army, and judges disputes himself, with no elected body able to overrule him
- (B) A queen attends ceremonies while an elected parliament passes all the laws
- (C) A monarch's only role is to formally open parliament each year
- (D) A king has no power and the people vote directly on every issue

58. A nation's leaders claim 'the majority elected us, so we may do anything.' The strongest constitutional response is:

- (A) The majority mandate indeed allows the leaders to do absolutely anything
- (B) Only the courts, not the constitution, can ever limit any leader
- (C) Election by the majority places leaders above the law
- (D) A majority mandate does not permit violating fundamental rights or ignoring the limits set by the constitution

59. Taken together, which set of features most reliably marks a country as a genuine democracy?

- (A) A large army, a long history, and a single ruling family
- (B) Regular votes only, with no protected rights or independent courts
- (C) Religious law as the sole basis of government with leaders chosen by clergy
- (D) Free and fair elections, equality before the law, protected rights, and an independent judiciary

60. Two students debate India's system. One says 'India copied the US, so its President runs the country like the US President.' What is the most accurate correction?

- (A) Unlike the US President, India's President is largely nominal, and the country is run by the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers answerable to Parliament
- (B) The student is right, because both Presidents are the real heads of government
- (C) India has no Prime Minister, so the President must run everything
- (D) India's President, like the US President, is directly elected by all voters and rules independently

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 9: Types of Governments — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	B	21	C	31	B	41	B	51	A
2	B	12	B	22	A	32	A	42	A	52	D
3	B	13	C	23	D	33	D	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	B	24	C	34	B	44	C	54	C
5	C	15	A	25	A	35	B	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	B	26	D	36	D	46	A	56	D
7	C	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	D	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	C	48	C	58	D
9	B	19	D	29	C	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	C	30	B	40	C	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (A) A genuine democracy rests on several pillars together: free elections, equality, rule of law, an independent judiciary and protected rights such as the freedom to criticise. The country whose courts can rule against the government and whose critics are safe meets these conditions. Treating elections alone as the whole test ignores that a regime can stage votes while crushing the other pillars, which is exactly what the second country does. The two are not equal merely because their election timetables match, since timing is not what makes a vote meaningful. And nothing about democracy forbids political parties; organised parties are normal within it.

2. (B) In a constitutional monarchy the crown is largely ceremonial and the real lawmaking power lies with an elected parliament, so a monarch and a democracy can coexist; the UK is the standard example. The blanket claim that any monarch blocks democracy confuses absolute monarchy (where the ruler truly governs) with constitutional monarchy. It is factually wrong that the UK has no monarch. And a monarch is not elected

at all; the position is inherited, which is precisely why the rest of the system must be democratic for the country to count as one.

3. (B) Whether a democracy is parliamentary or presidential turns on where real executive power sits. In India that power lies with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, drawn from and answerable to the legislature, while the President's role is largely nominal. Saying the President governs reverses the actual arrangement. The mere existence of two top posts does not decide the label; what matters is who wields real power. And the way the President is chosen does not make the system presidential; the parliamentary character comes from the executive depending on legislative confidence.

4. (B) The defining contrast is the relationship between the executive head and the legislature. A president is separately elected and works independently of the legislature; a prime minister is drawn from the legislature and stays in office only while it has confidence in the government. One distractor swaps these two definitions, which inverts the truth. Heads of government in these democracies are not hereditary monarchs. And courts do not appoint the head of government in either system; the executive owes its position to elections or to the legislature, not to judges.

5. (C) When one person wields absolute power over lawmaking, enforcement and judging without any constitutional limit or accountability, the government is a dictatorship. A constitutional monarchy is the opposite: there the monarch is only nominal and an elected body holds power. Direct democracy means the people themselves decide issues, not a single leader. And avoiding the title 'king' does not make a system a republic; a republic specifically requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state within a framework of law, which this regime lacks.

6. (A) It is true that a democracy can keep a king, and the explanation is precisely that in a constitutional monarchy the monarch holds only nominal power while an elected legislature actually governs; so the reason supplies the very mechanism that makes the assertion possible. Claiming the reason fails to explain the assertion misses this direct link. The reason is not false, since constitutional monarchies such as the UK demonstrate it. And the assertion is not false, because real constitutional monarchies are working democracies.

7. (C) Representative democracy is the practical choice for large populations because it is unworkable for millions to vote directly on every issue; instead they elect representatives to act on their behalf. The claim that direct democracy is illegal everywhere is false; small communities and referendums still use direct methods. Citizens in democracies are certainly allowed opinions, indeed that is fundamental to the system. And representatives are elected, not hereditary monarchs, which is what makes the arrangement democratic.

8. (D) A real democracy limits even majority power: fundamental rights are guaranteed to everyone, so a majority cannot vote away a minority's rights. The idea that the majority

may do anything it likes ignores these constitutional protections and the separation of powers that check it. There is no king deciding rights in a democracy. And minorities do vote in a democracy under universal adult franchise, so the premise that they cannot is false.

9. (B) Oligarchy means rule by a few; a small powerful group, often wealthy, controls the key decisions, unlike a democracy where power flows from all the people. Universal voting on each law describes a democracy, not an oligarchy. Rule by a single hereditary monarch is a monarchy, which concentrates power in one person rather than a few. And rule by religious leaders under sacred law is a theocracy, a different category defined by religion rather than by a wealthy clique.

10. (C) Although elections happen, real power is concentrated in one small wealthy group controlling courts, lawmakers and press, which is the hallmark of an oligarchy hidden behind a democratic facade. It cannot be a healthy democracy, because genuine democracy needs independent courts and a free press, both of which are captured here. There is no monarch, so it is not a constitutional monarchy. And it is not a direct democracy, since the people are not deciding issues themselves; a hidden elite is.

11. (B) Direct democracy means the people themselves decide an issue, exactly as when all residents personally vote on the park. Electing a council to decide is representative democracy, since decisions are made by chosen agents. A mayor inheriting office and deciding alone is a monarchical or hereditary arrangement, not democracy of either kind. And a parliament passing a budget is again representative democracy, because elected members, not the people directly, take the decision.

12. (B) A referendum is an instrument of direct democracy: the people themselves decide one specific question by voting on it. Choosing who sits in parliament is an ordinary election, a representative act, not a referendum. Judges do not cast the deciding votes in a referendum; the whole electorate does. And a king issuing a decision is monarchy, the opposite of a citizen-decided referendum.

13. (C) The UK is correctly classed as a constitutional monarchy that is also a parliamentary democracy, since an elected parliament governs under a nominal monarch. The USA is a presidential democracy, not a monarchy; it has no king. India is a parliamentary democracy, not presidential, because real power rests with the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers. And Saudi Arabia is an absolute monarchy, not a direct democracy, since the king truly holds and exercises power.

14. (B) Dividing government into legislature, executive and judiciary that work independently prevents any one organ from seizing total control and abusing it, which is why separation of powers safeguards democracy. Letting the executive run the courts would destroy judicial independence, the very danger separation guards against. Concentrating all authority in the legislature also defeats the purpose by removing the

checks. And it certainly does not remove the need for laws; it organises who makes, enforces and interprets them.

15. (A) The dividing line is who actually exercises power: in an absolute monarchy the king really governs, whereas in a constitutional monarchy the monarch is nominal and an elected legislature makes the laws. Saying both are purely ceremonial erases the absolute monarch's real power. Claiming the absolute king is elected is wrong; monarchs inherit their position in both kinds. And the last option reverses reality, since it is the constitutional monarch, not the absolute one, who lacks real lawmaking power.

16. (B) The two differ in where power lies: in Saudi Arabia the king actually rules (absolute monarchy), whereas in the UK the king is nominal and an elected parliament governs (constitutional monarchy and democracy). Claiming both kings rule absolutely is wrong about the UK. Merely having a monarch does not make a country a democracy, so saying both are democracies misses the point. And no monarch is elected; the UK's democratic status comes from its elected parliament, not from any election of the king.

17. (D) What sets a democracy apart from a dictatorship is that rulers are genuinely accountable to the people and can be removed through free elections, a check a dictatorship lacks. A capital city exists under any government, democratic or not, so it cannot be the distinguishing feature. The same is true of an army to defend borders and of national symbols like a flag and anthem; dictatorships have all of these too. Only accountability through free elections marks the democratic difference.

18. (C) Universal adult franchise means the vote belongs to every citizen above a set age, irrespective of wealth, gender or property; this equal right is central to democracy. Limiting the vote to landowners contradicts the word 'universal'. Restricting it to government members would make a tiny ruling clique, the opposite of democracy. And confining the vote to one gender denies the very equality that universal franchise guarantees.

19. (D) Judicial independence matters because courts can rule fairly even against the government, protecting laws and rights from abuse. A judiciary that always sides with the ruling party is not independent and offers no real check. One that takes orders from the head of government is controlled, not independent. And merely advising a king describes a system without genuine judicial power, again missing the protective role independence provides.

20. (C) A theocracy is defined by rule according to religious law administered by religious leaders, in contrast to a democracy where the people's elected will governs. Adults voting on all laws describes direct democracy, not theocracy. Rule by a wealthy few is oligarchy, defined by a clique rather than religion. And a nominal monarch with a governing parliament is a constitutional monarchy and democracy, which again does not match the religious basis of theocracy.

21. (C) Democracy means rule by the people; a republic adds the specific requirement that the head of state is elected rather than inheriting the throne, which is why the two terms are not synonyms. A republic does not abolish voting; elections are central to it. It does not keep a hereditary king; that would contradict the elected head of state. And it does not hand the choice to religious leaders, which would make it a theocracy rather than a republic.

22. (A) India is a democratic republic: power flows from the people through elected representatives (democratic) and its head of state, the President, is elected rather than hereditary (republic). It has no hereditary king, so the monarchy description fails. It is not governed by religious law, so it is not a theocracy. And it is not run by a small wealthy clique, which would be an oligarchy; India's elected institutions make it neither.

23. (D) Elections are necessary but not sufficient; the case where critics are jailed and courts obey the rulers shows a vote without rule of law, free speech or judicial independence, so it is not a real democracy. The other three describe countries where elections sit alongside the missing pillars: courts can overturn unlawful acts, citizens criticise freely, and minorities share equal rights. Those are the conditions that, together with voting, make a democracy genuine.

24. (C) A monarchy is defined by power being inherited within a family, usually by birth. Representative democracy chooses leaders by election, not birth. Oligarchy concentrates power in a small group, which may be wealthy but is not defined by hereditary succession of a single family throne. And a republic specifically requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state, the very opposite of inheritance by birth.

25. (A) Correctly, the legislature makes laws, the executive implements them, and the judiciary settles disputes and ensures laws are followed. The other options scramble these roles, for example assigning lawmaking to the judiciary or dispute-settling to the legislature, which misstates each organ's function. And it is wrong that all three only make laws; only the legislature makes laws, while the others enforce and interpret them.

26. (D) Interpreting the law and judging whether an act breaks it is the judicial function, so striking down an unlawful order is judicial. The legislative function is making laws, not judging them. The executive function is carrying out laws, and here the court is checking the executive rather than acting as one. And there is no real 'ceremonial' function among the three organs; this is judicial work.

27. (B) Accountability means rulers must answer to the people and can be removed by them; a dictatorship lacks this because its leader does not face genuine elections. Saying the ruler faces voters and can be voted out describes a democracy, not a dictatorship. Fully independent courts that remove the ruler also describe a system with checks the dictatorship suppresses. And a parliament that freely questions and replaces the ruler is again a democratic feature absent in a dictatorship.

28. (C) A head of government removable when the legislature withdraws confidence is the parliamentary model, while a separately elected head serving a fixed term independent of the legislature is the presidential model, so the order is parliamentary then presidential. Reversing them mislabels each. Neither description is about monarchy, since both involve elected heads of government, not kings. And theocracy and oligarchy concern religious rule and rule by a few, which do not match either description.

29. (C) The real divide between democracy and dictatorship is about who holds power and how the government is chosen and kept answerable. Population size does not determine the type of government; large and small countries can be either. The common language of citizens is unrelated to how power is held. And the amount of territory a country controls says nothing about whether its rulers are chosen by and accountable to the people.

30. (B) Rule of law means the law binds everyone, including the government and its leaders, not just ordinary people. The idea that leaders stand above the law contradicts this and points toward dictatorship. Saying only citizens must obey while rulers need not is the same error. And the law does not switch on only in election years; it applies continuously, which is part of what makes a democracy stable.

31. (B) Guaranteed rights such as free speech and equality, enforceable by an independent court even against the government, are the defining features of a democracy. A dictatorship suppresses such rights and controls the courts. An absolute monarchy concentrates power in a ruling king rather than protecting enforceable citizen rights. And an oligarchy keeps real power with a small group, which independent rights-enforcing courts would undercut, so none of these alternatives fit.

32. (A) Because India is a parliamentary democracy, the executive must keep the legislature's confidence; losing a no-confidence vote forces the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers to resign. The claim that nothing changes treats the system as presidential with a fixed-term head, which India is not. The President is not removed by a no-confidence vote in the government. And the Supreme Court has no role in dissolving itself or electing a government; that is not a judicial function.

33. (D) Democracy is majority rule tempered by protection of minority and individual rights through a constitution and separation of powers, so it is more than counting heads. Letting the majority override every right is exactly what democracy guards against. Letting only the minority decide would not be democracy either, since power must ultimately rest with the people broadly. And having no rules limiting any group describes lawlessness, not the rule-bound system democracy actually is.

34. (B) Rule by a small group, here the five richest families guarding their own interests, is the textbook definition of oligarchy. Direct democracy would have the people themselves deciding, not an exclusive clique. A constitutional monarchy would feature a nominal

monarch over an elected parliament, which is not present. And a theocracy would be governed by religious law and leaders, not by wealthy families, so oligarchy is the only fit.

35. (B) Democracy slides toward oligarchy when a small powerful group captures so much control that ordinary votes no longer matter. Higher voter turnout among ordinary citizens strengthens democracy rather than weakening it. More independent courts also reinforce democracy by checking power. And better-protected fundamental rights deepen democracy; each of these pushes away from oligarchy, not toward it.

36. (D) A constitutional monarchy is both a monarchy and a democracy: a hereditary monarch is the ceremonial head while an elected parliament actually governs. A king who personally makes and enforces every law is an absolute monarchy, not a democracy. A country that has banned elections under a sole ruling king is not a democracy at all. And a nation with no monarch but an elected president is a republic, a democracy without a monarchy, so it is not 'both'.

37. (A) These examples illustrate that the idea of people choosing their rulers is ancient and appeared across civilisations such as the Vajji in India and the republics of Greece and Rome. Saying democracy was invented in the twenty-first century ignores this long history. Claiming only one civilisation tried self-rule contradicts the very point of listing several. And insisting elections were impossible before modern times is refuted by ancient inscriptions and republics.

38. (C) The Uttaramerur inscriptions are prized as evidence that organised elections to choose local representatives existed in early India. They directly contradict the claim that India held no elections before modern times. They also disprove the notion that only hereditary kings ever held power, since they record elected representation. And they show elections were not unique to Greece, since India practised them too.

39. (D) The Lichchhavis were part of the Vajji confederation, an early example of leaders being chosen rather than simply inheriting power. The Mauryan Magadha empire was a monarchy, not the Vajji confederation. The Cholas were a southern kingdom associated with the Uttaramerur election records but not with the Lichchhavi clan. And the Kushanas were a northwestern empire unrelated to the Vajji, so only the Vajji is correct.

40. (C) The chapter's conclusion is that, for all its flaws, democracy is the most widely adopted form of government in the world today. Calling it the rarest contradicts how many countries use it. Saying no country uses it is plainly false. And equating it with dictatorship ignores the very differences, accountability, rights and elections, that the chapter emphasises throughout.

41. (B) A representative is someone the people choose to act and decide for them, which is the basis of representative democracy. Ruling because of one's birth describes a hereditary monarch, not an elected representative. Being merely the wealthiest person confers no

representative role on its own. And a judge appointed to settle disputes performs a judicial function, which is distinct from representing voters in lawmaking.

42. (A) In a democracy ultimate power comes from the people, whereas in an absolute monarchy it lies with the hereditary ruler; that is the correct contrast. Swapping them, so that democracy rests on a hereditary ruler and monarchy on the people, inverts both definitions. Courts interpret law but do not hold ultimate power in either system. And ultimate power in these forms is domestic, not vested in foreign governments.

43. (A) Separating power among independent legislature, executive and judiciary lets each check the others, preventing any one leader from dominating. Letting one leader appoint all judges and control lawmaking destroys those checks and concentrates power. Abolishing the courts removes the judicial check entirely. And placing the army over both the legislature and judiciary creates a different concentration of power, again undermining the goal.

44. (C) Elections must be free and fair so the result reflects the people's true choice; intimidation or rigging hollows out that choice. Treating elections as a meaningless formality denies their central democratic role. Allowing only the ruling party to contest removes real competition and choice. And deciding the outcome in advance is rigging by another name, the very thing free and fair elections prevent.

45. (A) Rule by religious leaders according to sacred law defines a theocracy. A republic has an elected, non-hereditary head of state, not clerical rule. A direct democracy has the people themselves deciding issues, not religious leaders. And a constitutional monarchy features a nominal monarch over an elected parliament, which is unrelated to rule by sacred law.

46. (A) The UK is democratic because real governing power lies with an elected parliament while the unelected monarch is merely nominal. The monarch is not secretly elected; the position is inherited. The monarch does not personally make laws after a vote; parliament makes the laws. And simply having a monarch does not make a country democratic, since absolute monarchies have monarchs yet are not democracies; it is the elected parliament that does.

47. (D) A dictatorship concentrates power without real constitutional limits and without genuine accountability to the people. Sharing power among freely elected representatives describes a democracy, not a dictatorship. People voting directly on every law describes direct democracy. And a purely ceremonial ruler describes a nominal monarch in a constitutional monarchy, the opposite of a dictator who actually wields power.

48. (C) Choosing a committee to decide on behalf of all students mirrors representative democracy, where elected representatives act for the people. An absolute monarchy would have one unelected ruler with inherited power, not a chosen committee. A theocracy would

have religious leaders deciding by sacred law. And a dictatorship would concentrate unchecked power in one person, none of which matches an elected, accountable committee.

49. (A) The assertion is false, because elections alone do not prove a democracy; a regime can stage votes while denying rights. The reason is true, since genuine democracy needs equality, protected rights and an independent judiciary. So the correct combination is a false assertion with a true reason. Treating both as true endorses the elections-alone fallacy. Treating both as false wrongly rejects the well-established list of democratic requirements. And the assertion is not true while the reason false, since it is the reverse.

50. (D) A democracy is failing when citizens cannot criticise the government and the courts never rule against it, because that signals suppressed speech and a captured judiciary. Open opposition campaigning and occasional opposition victories are healthy democratic signs. A free press reporting on government mistakes is exactly what democracy protects. And courts overturning unlawful government actions shows judicial independence working as it should, the opposite of failure.

51. (A) Both forms can be democracies, but a republic has an elected head of state, whereas a constitutional monarchy retains a hereditary monarch as a nominal head. The first distractor reverses these, wrongly giving the republic a king and the monarchy an elected head. Saying only the constitutional monarchy can be a democracy is false, since republics are democracies too. And claiming neither holds elections is wrong, because both elect their governing legislatures.

52. (D) Debating and passing a new law is the legislative function, the work of the lawmaking body. The executive function is carrying out laws once made, not passing them. The judicial function is interpreting laws and settling disputes, again not passing them. And there is no separate 'electoral' function among the three organs of government; electing representatives is how the legislature is formed, but lawmaking itself is legislative.

53. (B) An elected head of state with no monarch defines a republic. A constitutional monarchy by definition keeps a hereditary monarch, even if nominal, so it cannot fit a country with no king or queen. An absolute monarchy has a ruling hereditary king, again contradicting the absence of a monarch. And a theocracy is ruled by religious leaders under sacred law, which the description does not mention, so republic is correct.

54. (C) In a parliamentary democracy the executive comes from the legislature and remains in power only while it keeps the legislature's confidence. A separately elected, irremovable executive describes a presidential system instead. The executive and legislature are not one single person; they are distinct bodies with a confidence relationship. And the executive does not control or abolish the legislature at will, which would destroy the accountability that defines the parliamentary form.

55. (D) A country where a monarch only reigns while an elected parliament governs under a constitution disproves the idea that any monarchy rules out democracy. It does not disprove that democracies hold elections; this country does hold them. It does not disprove that monarchs inherit their position; this monarch did. And it does not disprove that parliaments make laws; that is exactly what its parliament does, so only the king-blocks-democracy claim is refuted.

56. (D) Democracies enforce accountability because citizens can question leaders and remove them through elections, a check a dictator escapes. The claim that citizens vote dictators out yearly reverses reality; dictatorships lack genuine removal mechanisms. Leaders are not equally answerable in both, which is the whole distinction. And in a democracy leaders are bound by the law and must answer to the people, so saying they are above the law contradicts the democratic principle.

57. (A) An absolute monarchy is one where the king actually issues laws, commands forces and judges disputes with no elected body able to overrule him. A queen attending ceremonies while parliament legislates is a constitutional monarchy, the opposite case. A monarch whose only role is to open parliament is also nominal, hence constitutional. And a powerless king with the people voting directly describes a direct democracy that merely retains a figurehead, not an absolute monarchy.

58. (D) Winning a majority does not license violating fundamental rights or breaching constitutional limits; a constitution binds even an elected majority. The view that a mandate permits anything is exactly the abuse constitutions prevent. Saying only courts and never the constitution can limit leaders misstates how power is checked, since courts apply the constitution itself. And election by a majority does not place leaders above the law; rule of law still binds them.

59. (D) A genuine democracy is marked by free and fair elections together with equality before the law, protected rights and an independent judiciary; these features reinforce one another. A large army, long history and ruling family say nothing about democracy and even hint at concentrated power. Regular votes with no rights or independent courts is the elections-only trap that falls short. And government solely on religious law with clergy choosing leaders describes a theocracy, not a democracy.

60. (A) India and the USA differ in form: the US President is the real head of government in a presidential system, but India's President is largely nominal while the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers, answerable to Parliament, actually govern in a parliamentary system. Treating both Presidents as real heads of government ignores this difference. India does have a Prime Minister, so the claim that the President must run everything is false. And India's President is not directly elected by all voters nor does the office rule independently, so the comparison to the US presidency does not hold.